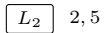
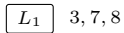


locally ordered producers
appear noncontiguously



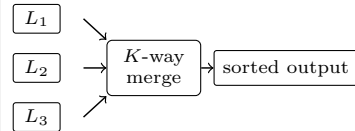
not just contiguous natural runs

(a) interleaved input streams



single scan assigns each key
to the leftmost feasible ladder

(b) ladder decomposition



same ladders merged by
a K -way tournament

(c) adaptive merge